

The “Course Materials” link on the page takes one to the page offering links organised chapter-wise. Here one can see that there are 17 chapters in the course. Under the chapter link one can access the sites that offer information about the topic. The links span an entire range of Web sites, though most are other educational institutions. The eclectic nature of the selection ensures that a student gets the best information as judged by Dr Herman, available on the Net. This approach frees the student from being restricted to a single source of information. The drawback is the loss of continuity since a student is expected to visit different sites to complete a topic. Besides educational material, there are quizzes also offered on the same page under the “Sample Quizzes/Exams” link.

For even more content, students also visit the “Text Website” link which takes one to the companion Web site of the book “Physics, Sixth Edition by John D. Cutnell and Kenneth W. Johnson”, published by Wiley. The Web site offers a lot of additional learning tools and is supposed to augment the content in the textbook. The “Concept Simulation Link” takes a student to a host of Java applets and Flash animations which can be used to experiment with the various concepts. The applets are arranged chapter-wise, and each is accompanied by a textual description on how to use it, besides an audio introduction offering a background for the applet’s purpose. In case of animations, a commentary accompanies the animation explaining the related concept and walking a student through the different steps. The Self Assessment Tests link and Practice MCAT Quizzes link offer an avenue for the student to test his knowledge. The content on the site is accessible either chapter-wise or category-wise from the menu in the right sidebar.

It is actually easy to see that the 17 chapters on Dr Herman’s page correspond to the 17 chapters of the Wiley book. Dr Herman has successfully avoided copyright issues by using content freely available on the Net to explain the textual matter, and by using the additional content offered for free by the publisher has managed to offer the best of both worlds.